

Refine Judgement, Explanation, and Evidence Use in Finance

Use mathematics to check, justify and explain your financial decisions.

Step 12

Lower Elementary
(Grades 3–4)

★ Today I am learning to refine my judgement, explain my thinking and use evidence in finance.

1. Is it a Good Deal?

Decide if each deal is a good deal. Show your working and explain why.
Tick ✓ Good Deal or ✗ Not a Good Deal.

- a) Regular price: \$48
Sale: 20% off



20% OFF

☐ Good Deal ☐ Not a Good Deal

Why? _____

- b) Buy 2 board games
Total price: \$60
Normal price each: \$38



☐ Good Deal ☐ Not a Good Deal

Why? _____

2. Compare and Justify

You want to buy a tablet.

Compare the three options.

Which option is the best choice for you?

Explain and justify your answer using numbers.



Option A

Price: \$260
10% off
2-year warranty

Option B

Price: \$250
No discount
2-year warranty

Option C

Price: \$240
Free case
1-year warranty

Best choice: ☐ Option A ☐ Option B ☐ Option C

Justify your answer with evidence and calculations.

3. Budget Check

Liam made a budget for his week.

Use evidence to decide if his plan is sensible.

Tick ✓ Yes, Sensible or ✗ No, Not Sensible.

Item	Planned (\$)	Reasonable? (Yes/No)	Why? Give evidence.
Food	\$28	☐ Yes ☐ No	_____
Transport	\$15	☐ Yes ☐ No	_____
Fun	\$25	☐ Yes ☐ No	_____
Saving	\$10	☐ Yes ☐ No	_____
Total	\$78		

He has \$80 for the week.

Does he have enough money? ☐ Yes ☐ No Why? _____

What could he change to improve his plan? _____

4. Explain Your Decision

You want to plan a birthday party for 12 friends.

You have a budget of \$150.

Choose a plan. Explain why it is the best choice.



Plan	Details	Total Cost
A	- Pizza: \$60 - Drinks: \$18 - Decorations: \$15 - Party bags: \$12	\$ _____
B	- Burgers: \$55 - Drinks: \$16 - Decorations: \$20 - Party bags: \$10	\$ _____
C	- Sandwiches: \$45 - Drinks: \$15 - Decorations: \$18 - Party bags: \$12	\$ _____

Best plan: ☐ Plan A ☐ Plan B ☐ Plan C

Explain and justify your choice using numbers and reasons.

5. Real-Life Scenario

The Carter family is planning a weekend camping trip.
They have \$300 to spend.



Estimated Costs	Cost (\$)
Camping gear (tent, stove, etc.)	\$120
Food	\$85
Fuel	\$45
Activities (canoeing, park fees)	\$35
Souvenirs	\$25
Total Estimated Cost	\$ _____

Questions

- What is the total estimated cost?
\$ _____
- Will \$300 be enough?
☐ Yes ☐ No
- How much money will be left over or needed?
\$ _____
- Suggest one way the family could save money.

6. Use Evidence to Make a Recommendation

Your class is raising money for a local animal shelter.

Three fundraising ideas are suggested.

Use the table to recommend the best idea.

Idea	Estimated Income (\$)	Estimated Costs (\$)	Estimated Profit (\$)	Your Recommendation (Best / Not Best)
Bake Sale	\$180	\$40	\$ _____	_____
Car Wash	\$220	\$60	\$ _____	_____
Raffle	\$250	\$90	\$ _____	_____

Which idea do you recommend? _____

Why? Use numbers and reasons as evidence. _____

My Learning Check

Circle how confident you feel.



I understand this well.



I need more practice.



I need help.

I used...



calculations ☐



tables ☐



percentages ☐



money skills ☐

Today I learned...

One thing I did well: _____

One thing I will improve: _____



Think About It!

Why is it important to use maths and evidence when making financial decisions?
